

## Scripting Progress

**WHEN APARNA PUROHIT** started working some two decades ago, she was the only woman in the whole production crew, besides the actress. Things have, of course, changed since then. Today, when Amazon Prime Video backs some of the most progressive shows of our times, like *Guilty Minds* and *Jubilee*, among others, the decisions have a lot to do with Purohit's life experiences. "I firmly believe that incorporating the female perspective is indispensable for nuanced, authentic and compelling storytelling. In line with this conviction, we have mandated the presence of women in our writers' rooms. Notably, over half of the original shows and films in production at Prime Video have women in significant HOD positions, and feature women



### APARNA PUROHIT

44, HEAD OF INDIA AND SEA ORIGINALS, AMAZON PRIME VIDEO

in writers' rooms," she says, poignantly recalling a time when she would often be excluded from outdoor shoots because she is a woman. Purohit says a positive change can come through mentorship programmes, encouraging inclusive storytelling, and creating safe and supportive work environments.

Her philosophy, she says, is that every show or

movie on the platform should be someone's favourite. "Regardless of the genre or storytelling style, this principle remains steadfast...

it's about crafting narratives that do justice to all the characters, regardless of whether they are a man or a woman." **BT**

— BY PRERNA LIDHOO

#### WHAT KEEPS ME GOING

Just when you feel you've learnt something, its 2.0 version is in, and it's time to learn again

#### A LIFE LESSON LEARNT ON THE JOB

Women need to learn not to be passive and accepting

## BATTLING FOR REFORMS

**IN THE MIDST** of G20 meetings during India's presidency, Ashima Goyal, then chairing a Task Force on Multilateral Development Banks (MDBs), got a chance to visit Mysore Palace. Goyal, one of three external members on the Reserve Bank of India's monetary policy committee, was reminded of Tipu Sultan, the 18th century ruler of Mysore who had allied with France. "This is the city with a

history of global involvement," she recalls saying then. She believes with the G20 presidency passing from Indonesia to India, now to Brazil, and then to South Africa—all emerging markets—MDB reforms can be brought to fruition. "There is scope for MDBs to trigger private investments," says Goyal, Emeritus Professor at the Mumbai-headquartered Indira Gandhi Institute of Development Research. **BT**

— BY ANAND ADHIKARI

### ASHIMA GOYAL

67, MEMBER, RBI'S MONETARY POLICY COMMITTEE



## IN TOP GEAR

Starting off as a management trainee at Sundram Fasteners (SFL) in 1990, Arathi Krishna rose through the ranks. Nearly three decades later, she became the MD in 2018, succeeding her father after his retirement. SFL, earlier a part of the erstwhile \$8.5 billion TVS Group, is now



### ARATHI KRISHNA

55, MD, SUNDARAM FASTENERS

free to chart its own course after the group restructured last year. Already on top, she is building SFL into a global brand through innovation as she aims to transform it from a component maker to a supplier of sub-assemblies to EV players. "We have a target of 50 per cent of our top line to be non-auto and EV in five years," says Krishna. Seems she is ready for the ride. **BT**

— BY VIDYA S.